Thank You for Your Purchase!

I hope you find the template and tutorial helpful! If you have any questions or feedback, I'd love to hear from you.

My slab-building system is simple: cut, score, slip, and join. That's it. With this technique you can build almost anything, from mugs to vases.

Feel free to reach out via email at fran@fromfran.com or send me a message on Instagram @from_fran. If you create something with this template, tag me - I love seeing your work!

Looking for more? Explore my other pottery templates and guides for even more ways to bring your ideas to life.

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happy making!

xoxo Fran

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MAKING THE COCOA MUG SLAB TEMPLATE WITH ME



WATCH HERE

GLAZING THE COCOA MUG WITH ME



WATCH HERE

What You'll Need



Clay



Vinegar



Bucket w/ water



Wire clay cutter



Canvas



Angle cutter tool



Wood modeling tool



Rib tool



Scoring tool



Brush



Sponge



Pillow foam



Wood sticks



Rolling pin

optional



Cookie cutters



Extruder



Balsa wood



Wood base

Before You Begin & Intel

Printing Guidelines

The templates from my collection can be printed at 100% scale, but remember that they work at any scale. You can size up or down in your printer settings to make your shapes larger or smaller depending on your preference.



The Three Essential Parts

The templates include 3 parts:

- Body
- Base
- Handle

Assembly Process

The slab-building sequence moves from forming the *Body* to adding the *Bottom*, then attaching *Handle*. This same sequence technique can be used for building any of my designs, from simple mugs to more complex forms.

Clay Moisture

If your clay feels too wet and sticky, lay it on your canvas for a few minutes. The canvas will absorb some of the excess moisture, making the clay easier to work with. Just be careful not to let it dry out too much.

Scale and Shrinkage

- Print at 100% scale or scale up or down depending on your preference

Template Preparation

- Use high-quality, printable paper
- Print template at full size
- Carefully cut out each template piece
- Optional: Laminate for repeated use or trace onto balsa wood
- Optional: Cookie cutters are great for cutting bases, plates, and/or handles

Clay Preparation Tips

- Recommended clay thickness: 3-5mm (1/8 - 1/4 inch)
- Roll clay on canvas or smooth surface
- Flip and turn many times if your slab is too thick
- Use consistent pressure when rolling for even thickness
- If clay is too wet, let it rest 10-15 minutes after rolling for optimal workability

Cutting Guidelines

- Place template on rolled clay
- Use craft knife to trace around template
- Cut smoothly and steadily
- Remove excess clay carefully
- Store excess clay in a bag and use in other project

Slab Making Step by Step



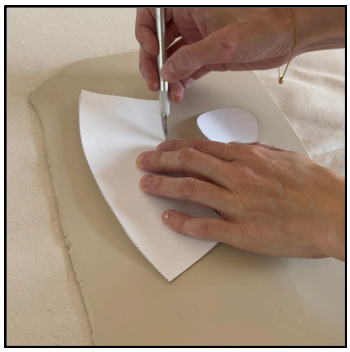
Roll

Roll out your clay into an even slab using a rolling pin.



Compress

Use a rib tool to compress and smooth the clay surface.



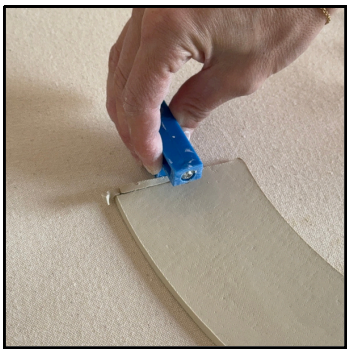
Cut

Cut the slab to your desired shape using a template.



⋆.˚ Tip ⋆.˚

Transfer the template to a balsa wood shape and use cookie cutters.



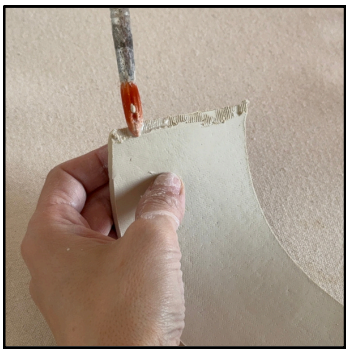
Cut

Cut both edges using an angle cutter tool. Remember to flip and turn after cutting the first edge.



Score

Create texture on both edges.



Brush slip

Apply slip (vinegar) to the scored areas.



Curve and press

Curve the clay into a cylinder shape and firmly press scored and slipped edges together.



Smooth

Smooth the interior with a wooden tool.



Flip

Turn the piece over carefully to work on the other side.



Score

Create texture on the base.



Brush slip

Apply slip to the newly scored area.



Add bottom

Attach the circular base to create the bottom.



Nice!

Check your work and assess overall shape.



Flip and join

Turn and connect the base to the body.



Join

Secure all connections. Push the clay of the base into the body.



Tap

Gently tap , many times, refine connect.



Tap again

Continue refining the form for evenness.



Clean rim

Smooth and refine the top edge with a sponge.



Clean base

Smooth and refine the bottom edge.



Smoth interior

Refine the inside surface with a brush.



Clean handle

Prep the handle area for attachment.



Score handle

Create texture on the handle connection point.



Score body

Create texture on the cup where handle will attach.



Attach

Connect the handle to the cup body.



Smooth

Blend connection points on both sides. Use your wood tool and brush.



Smooth

Use your finger to smooth out any imperfections.



Let Dry

Drying time will depend on your climate and clay thickness – I usually wait about 2 days until they're fully bone dry.



Next steps

Once completely dry, your pieces are ready for bisque firing. After the bisque firing, you can glaze them as you wish.

Wavy Plate Step-by-Step



Roll

Roll out your clay into an even slab using a rolling pin.



Compress

Use a rib tool to compress and smooth the clay surface.



Cut

Cut the slab using a cake or cookie cuter or use the Bread & Butter Template.



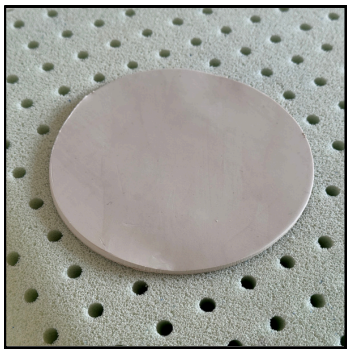
Cut

Cut around the template.



Remove

Remove excess clay from around your circle.



Foam

Place a piece of foam on your work surface.



Wood Base

Position your wooden base in the center of the clay circle



Push

Gently press the wooden base down into the clay.



Ta-da

Apply even pressure until you achieve your desired ruffle effect.

Troubleshooting Cracks



Vinegar

Keep white vinegar handy - it's the perfect solution for repairing hairline cracks in unfired clay. The mild acid in vinegar helps reactivate the clay surface for seamless repairs.



Identify

Carefully inspect your piece for hairline cracks. Even tiny fissures like these can weaken your work, but they're completely fixable with the right technique.



Identify

Hairline cracks can appear at different stages of clay drying.



Apply

Use a fine brush to apply vinegar directly to the hairline crack. Work the vinegar into the crack with gentle, controlled strokes to help dissolve and reactivate the clay.



Smooth

After application, you'll notice the clay becomes more workable. The crack should begin to disappear as the vinegar breaks down the hardened edges.



Blend

Continue working the area with your brush, gently blending the edges of the crack into the surrounding clay. Apply more vinegar as needed until the surface becomes uniform.



Refine

Use a wooden tool to further smooth and compress the repaired area, eliminating any remaining trace of the crack and creating a seamless surface.



Bray Patch

For cracks that appear after firing or when attached pieces have broken off, use B-Ray Patch. This specialized repair material bonds permanently to fired clay and can be sanded smooth once dry.

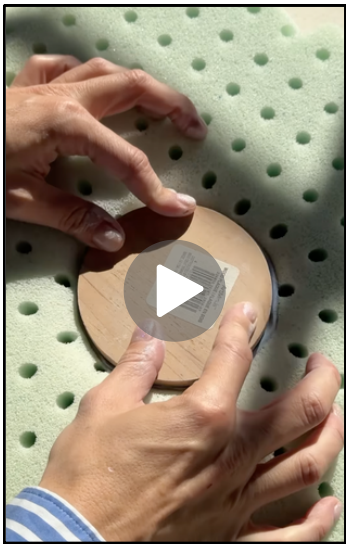
Video Demos

From crafting perfect saucers to mastering half-moon espresso cups, my Instagram @from_fran and YouTube is your go-to pottery tutorial hub.

Learn, create, and transform clay into art – one short demo at a time.

Questions about the templates or clay techniques?

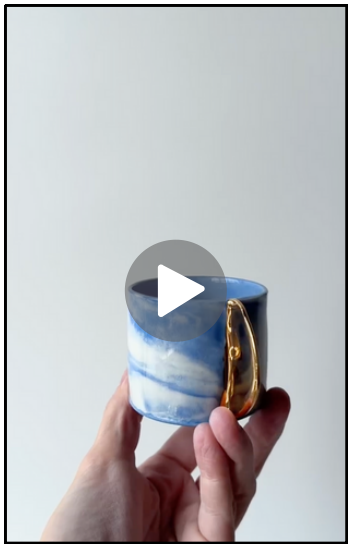
I'm here to help! Drop me a line at fran@fromfran.com



From Slab to Plate



From Slab to Mug



From Slab to Espresso

